My Personal Development Plan

Name:	**Muhammad Imran**
Course:	**MSc. Data Science for Business**
Date:	**12/10/2025**
Updated:	**15/10/2025**

Part One- SWOT Analysis

STRENGTHS Think about: What experience and knowledge do I have? What do I do well? What are my skills and capabilities? What do I know about the subject? What do others think? What is my attitude to this?	**WEAKNESSES** Think about: What are the potential barriers? What could I improve? What should I avoid? What resources do I lack? What do others think?
I consider teamwork being one of my key strengths. I have been an excellent team player since my childhood, contributing meaningfully to the team goals and working together is something I really enjoy myself. I also have good knowledge and skills to be a confident data scientist. In addition to that, I am also good at breaking down complex tasks into simple easy steps and solve the problems. It not only helped me pursue statistical degree but also enjoy the coursework. I am adaptable to changing situations and it helped me grow both personally and professionally in the new Scottish culture. Others think of me as a friendly and caring guy who loves social gatherings and likes to expand his horizons. I also enjoy my excellent personal and professional ethics and communication skills. I have good writing skills in me, to share my feelings and deliver ideas. This guided me write blog posts on medium and study the world by reading other authors. In addition, I also enjoy planning things beforehand that includes one of my key strengths.	My weakness includes that I am emotionally sensitive to hard challenges and struggles to best fit to the environment. This could be improved by having around some groups of friends and discussing good times. I might also fear public speaking and lack that much confidence to share my ideas to large audience. Others think of me as friendly and honest person but at the same time find me a talkative guy. I also struggles in creating a budget plan and stick to it, because sometimes when I go for holidays or trips, I spend unknowingly… that seems sad, and I need to work to groom it up.
OPPORTUNITIES Think about: What interests me in this? What might be possible? What would I like to do if nothing holds me back? What is available? What can I learn? What can I develop?	**THREATS** Think about: What happens if I struggle? What if I lose interest? What are the limitations? What is holding me back? What might prevent me meeting goals?
I have lots of opportunities to land in my career like learning artificial intelligence and build predictive models. With this not only I can contribute my best as data scientist but also demand forecast and predict future using machine learning techniques. I would also like to learn how chatbots are built and what way I can embed my skills in the era of AI. So, learning Gen AI skills and business analytics techniques along with data science expertise will help me grow professionally in my journey and open new paths for my career. For this I am learning Python and working towards some BI tools that will pay me best.	Even if I struggle sparing much time to learn AI concepts and building effective business models I can still contribute meaningfully to my current profession and achieve the goals. Therefore, it won't be a high-level threat… but what holding me back is the lack of time to learn new skills along with my course modules. But I am optimistic to dedicate extra efforts, achieve the goals and overcome the challenges. It will not only help me grow in the future but also pay me higher for my dedication.

Part Two- Skills Audit

Skill/Ability definition	Current skills level (1, 2, 3)	Your current evidence of this skill (evidence /examples both positive and negative)
Interpersonal Skills		
1. Comfortable in social situations 2. Appreciates the views of others 3. Adjusts behaviour to account for other people 4. Maintains good communication within groups of people	2 3 3 3	I contribute meaningfully and enjoy social gatherings, that I enjoyed during my time at the High School and University. Joining the sports team and working with clubs and societies shows I am comfortable in social situations and sometimes enjoy a lot. Listen everyone because I believe others view can pay you smart and make you learn more. I learned this kind of appreciation during my university life… where you are listened and your views are valued, something helpful for everyone's grooming. Absolutely I am adaptable and enjoy accounting for other people and spending quality time with them. I am an active member of Striling Sports Union and have met with people of different values and beliefs and account for their views to adjust in a well-connected society. Yes, and I think good communication within your group is a key to success. It helps you share your ideas as groups are excellent to learn, grow and collaborate with each other.
Management Skills		
1. Organises self to complete set tasks 2. Sets and achieves objectives 3. Plans best use of resources for self and others	3 3 3	I am quite Judging and plans everything beforehand, it helped me grow both personally and professionally. Organizing tasks also helps me achieve goals, do assignments timely and plan days for effective learning. I like to set objectives and work hard for achieving them, that I learned in my days at the University of Stirling. Learning in an organised way not only help getting the goals but also plan things accordingly. I have good access to resources in my university i.e., library material, study spaces, online learning and canvas slides that gave me confidence to use them effectively and gain maximum advantages in getting high grades during my studies and support others' too.

Learning Skills		
1. Willing to learn 2. Keen to learn and has a plan 3. Tries to improve learning ability 4. Strategic about learning for self and others	3 3 2 2	I always like to learn new skills, problem solving techniques and data analytics concepts best to help me land my first data science job. Having a clear plan of learning and dedicating your efforts really helps you learn it quickly. So, I love to have plans and go step by step like learning python I will first learn data types, then functions and lastly will move to libraries. Looking to improve your learning experience is a part of learning so I always look for ways to improve my productivity, communication and creative skills. I am quite good at learning other strengths and tries to inculcate those skills in myself so I might be able to reflect for self and others' abilities and what areas are there to improve.
Written Communication		
1. Uses accurate language 2. Writes with the reader in mind 3. Can write for a variety of purposes	3 3 2	Language is a key for sharing feelings, delivering ideas and writing effectively. So, yes, I feel comfortable using appropriate language when doing assignments, writing emails and working on academic projects. Writing according to the readers' mind helps catch attention, that aligns with my values. Yes, I have ability to write both academic and social aspects of life. I like to read blog posts on medium and have written some as well.
Verbal Communication		
1. Can hold a conversation 2. Is skilled in conversation and discussion 3. Can help others communicate	3 2 3	I believe holding an effective communication and collaborate effectively with group members is very important when holding conversations, and I am quite well with it. I am skilled in conversation and discuss ideas seamlessly but sometimes also prefer me time. I help others communicate and like to listen to them effectively and giving confidence to speak.
Problem-Solving		
1. Can identify a problem 2. Can identify solutions 3. Can analyse relevant information and investigate options 4. Can apply creative thinking in search of a solution	3 3 2 3	My skills in identifying the problem are excellent that guided me to purse master's in data science. I also have good problem-solving skills; my assignments and projects argue the statement and am motivated to identify and implement future business solutions in my profession. I worked on my dissertation project where I had to get relevant information and investigate options to identify the solutions and pick the right one. So, yes, I am quite good at it.

		I am working on delivering a sustainable project of the year in collaboration with Uniforce to support green transitions in Scotland that shows my creativity and excellent approach in delivering solutions.
Information & Communication Technology		
1. Has basic computer skills 2. Can use a range of software 3. Can manage ICT facilities	3 3 3	I have an outstanding computer skills and digital literacy that I learned during my high school and university time and is a must-have skill in the current era of AI. Of course, my proficiency with multiple software like Anaconda, Microsoft 365, R Studio, MATLAB, GitHub and Azure along with range of others make me stand out as a good data scientist. I am comfortable working with both hardware and software communication systems and my courses like IoT, Machine Learning, Software Engineering and Business Analytics represent that.
Numbers and Data		
1. Can do basic arithmetic operations 2. Can interpret graphs and tables 3. Can estimate, calculate and manipulate data 4. Can design numerical investigations	3 3 3 3	I am good at maths and can perform basic algorithmic operations very well, and I learned these skills during my whole academic years. I have excellent practice working with Tableau, Excel, and BI tools that demonstrate my good graphic interruption and dashboard skills. Yes, I like manipulating data, cleaning and performing calculations on it and do analytical work best for being a successful data scientist. Designing numerical investigation is something I have really being working on it since my childhood and grasps good knowledge of representing and designing numerical data.
Team Working		
1. Can work with others 2. Ability to be an effective member of a team 3. Ability to lead and motivate a team	3 3 3	Teamwork is my passion, and I enjoy working in groups. I learned this skill during my time at the University of Stirling and have passion to work with others well. I have been an excellent member of lots of teams during my time at schools, and college where I learned how you can perform at your best in team and achieve the goals. I am leading a team of four member working with Uniforce on real-world project that shows I have outstanding ability to lead and manage team and collaborate with each for setting up the goals.
Commercial Awareness		
1. Have an understanding of the business environment 2. Can speculate about the future 3. Understand the past to predict the future	2 3	I have a good understanding of the business world but need to learn more about market research, how to achieve set targets, understand competitors, and perform benchmarking. For sure and I have done some real projects to forecast future demand for bike usage in Stirling.

	3	I think understanding past to predict the future is the backbone of business analytics and I have good understanding of it that helped me get through my dissertation project.
Career Management Skills		
1. Has some concept of applying own skills to job applications 2. Understands self and how different jobs might suit 3. Takes a strategic approach to career planning 4. Is flexible, adaptable and proactive about careers	3 2 2 2	I know very well how I can apply my concepts to job applications and work for the success of the organization. I am aware of myself but still need to work on my career plannings and how different jobs might suit well to me. I take strategic approach to career planning but feels like I lag and must draw clear map of my skills and how these can be aligned with the current market demands. Being flexible and adaptable is a key to be successful in your professional career, I am good at it and like to be proactive about my careers, organising meetings with career teams will be best in that.

Part Three- Personal Short- term Smart Goals

Personal Goals				
OBJECTIVES What do I want to be able to do better? What do I want to achieve?	**ACTIONS** What will I do to achieve this?	**SUPPORT** What support and resources will I need?	**SUCCESS CRITERIA** How will I recognise/provide evidence of my success? How will I review and measure my improvement?	**TARGET DATES FOR REVIEW / COMPLETION**
I want to land my first job as a data scientist.	Learn SQL, Python and R along with basic statistics.	I need Coursera subscription, dedicate enough time to organise meetings with career teams and spend schedule time to boost up my skills.	I need minimum of £42,000 salary range per annum with a sponsorship after six – twelve months job duration.	Before the end of May 2026, when my visa expires.
To save some money and make a happy life with good girl.	I need to draw budget plans and stick to it for growing my savings.	I would go with cash ISA, invest in asset management companies to grow my income.	I planned to save more than £20,000 per annum with my first job to arrange marriage expenses.	By the end of 2027.
In long-term my plan involves exploring the world and lightning it up by coming with innovative solutions in technology.	This will be possible with favourable amount of money saved, and right skills for advancing the AI world.	I need to work on gaining driving license, Amex card and Mercedes car so I can travel with them like I wish.	For achieving these goals, I need minimum of £50,000 of savings, to visit each corner of the world.	Within the next ten years.

Part Four- My Personal Objectives

Personal Development Objectives
Short Term Goals
My short-term goals are to land my first job as Data Scientist and work closely with the company's objectives. It will help me manage my expenses and gain experience for data analytics environment by solving real-world problems. I also planned to land a sponsored job that will help me stay longer in the Scotland, explore its natural beauty and groom myself professionally.
Medium Term Goals
My medium-term goals include building a new house by savings from my job and then have a good family to share your happiness with. It will make me feel strong and explore Europe with my fiancé. I would also work hard in parallel to learn machine learning and artificial intelligence concepts and land my second job as Data Scientist/Business Analyst in JP Morgan Chase & Co. and build the future of AI.
Long Term Goals
The long-term goals include having a girl, with car and excellent AI skills to advance the world in the field of technology… having lots of money to visit around the globe, including the continents of Europe and America. It will help me find intrinsic feeling of happiness and enjoy the true life.

Part Five- My Picture of Success